

THE ART OF FAST BOWLING



For the average Indian, cricket is no mere sport but a way of life. We are captivated by every aspect of the game right from the towering sixes driven by sheer power, the delicate touch of an elegant cover drive, the spectacular catch at cover, the satisfying thud of the ball hitting the stumps, and even the cunning deception of a well-disguised googly.

For many, however, it's the raw intensity of fast bowling that truly mesmerises. The satisfying crack of the ball against the bat, the heart-stopping moment when it narrowly misses the edge, and the unpredictable bounce off the pitch collectively contributes to the thrill

Fast bowling, the very spearhead of cricket, also accounts for a disproportionate share of injuries, necessitating both flawless technique and robust physical conditioning to reduce injury risk. These techniques can be broadly classified into three categories, distinguished by their action and the bowler's use of their hips.

Side-on: This relies heavily on hip rotation to generate power. While efficient, this forceful twisting motion places significant stress on the lower back. The shoulder also endures considerable strain from the rapid arm rotation and high forces involved.

Front-on: This action emphasizes linear momentum, relying more on shoulder and arm speed, with the torso facing the batsman at delivery. The front leg absorbs a tremendous impact upon landing, bearing the brunt of the force.

Mixed/Semi-open: The semi-open bowling action blends the power-generating lower body mechanics of a side-on style (emphasizing hip rotation) with the more linear, shoulder-driven upper body of a front-on approach. This combination results in complex, often asymmetrical movements, placing inconsistent loads on the body and increasing the potential for injury.

***Halt Sports Injuries (HSI) : An Ortho One Initiative to create awareness through learning sessions and provide medical support at subsidised cost for deserving sports persons.
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